

Business Analyst - Retail & Store Operations

Client: Barnes & Noble

Location: New York, NY (exact site TBC at submission)

Work Model: Onsite

Employment Type: W2 Contract

Duration: 18 months (extension possible, based on funding/performance)

Target Start Date: September 21, 2026

Pay Rate: \$45-\$55/hr W2 (DOE)

Experience Level: 3-5 years

ID: 1067743-BA-928

Role Overview

The analyst will work directly with business stakeholders to understand operational requirements, define reporting needs, analyze performance trends, and translate business questions into actionable insights and measurable KPIs. The ideal candidate will be comfortable working between **business and technical teams**, with strong SQL/BI capabilities and the ability to communicate analytical findings to non-technical stakeholders.

Key Responsibilities

Business Analysis & Requirements

- Partner with Store Operations and business stakeholders to understand business needs and reporting requirements.
- Conduct requirements-gathering sessions and translate business problems into clear analytical and reporting requirements.
- Document business requirements, functional specifications, process flows, KPI definitions, and acceptance criteria.
- Identify gaps between current-state processes and desired business outcomes.
- Work with technical teams to ensure business requirements are accurately implemented.

Business & Operational Analysis

- Analyze store and operational performance data to identify trends, exceptions, and opportunities for improvement.
- Evaluate operational KPIs and investigate significant variances or performance issues.
- Perform root-cause analysis by combining business context with data-driven analysis.
- Develop recommendations based on findings and communicate potential business impact.
- Support ad-hoc analysis for operational and management decisions.

KPI & Reporting

- Define business KPIs, reporting requirements, calculation logic, and performance measures in collaboration with stakeholders.
- Develop and maintain recurring management reports and operational dashboards.
- Use **Power BI or Tableau** to present trends, KPIs, drill-downs, and exception analysis.
- Validate reports against business requirements and source data before release.
- Ensure consistent definitions and interpretation of operational metrics across business teams.

Data Analysis & SQL

- Use SQL to extract, join, aggregate, and validate data from multiple business systems.
- Reconcile data across operational and reporting environments.
- Perform data validation and investigate discrepancies affecting business reporting.
- Work with technical teams to identify whether issues originate from source systems, transformation logic, or business processes.
- Use Excel extensively for analysis, reconciliation, and business reporting.

Process Improvement & Automation

- Identify manual, repetitive, or Excel-based processes that can be improved or automated.
- Analyze existing business workflows and recommend process improvements.
- Work with technical teams to define automation requirements and validate delivered solutions.
- Support implementation of standardized and repeatable reporting processes.

Stakeholder & Cross-Functional Collaboration

- Serve as a liaison between Store Operations, business users, data/BI teams, and technical teams.
- Present analytical findings and recommendations to business stakeholders.
- Facilitate discussions around KPI definitions, reporting priorities, and business requirements.
- Coordinate issue resolution when reporting or operational data does not meet business expectations.
- Maintain clear documentation of requirements, processes, KPIs, and reporting logic.

Required Qualifications

- **3+ years of experience as a Business Analyst, Business Data Analyst, Reporting Analyst, or similar role.**
- Strong experience gathering and documenting business requirements.

- Proven ability to translate business requirements into **KPIs, reports, dashboards, and analytical solutions**.
- Strong SQL skills including joins, CTEs, aggregations, subqueries, and window functions.
- Hands-on experience with **Power BI or Tableau**.
- Advanced Excel skills including PivotTables, lookups, formulas, and data reconciliation.
- Experience analyzing operational or transactional business data.
- Strong problem-solving and root-cause-analysis capabilities.
- Excellent written and verbal communication skills.
- Ability to communicate technical/analytical findings to non-technical stakeholders.
- Bachelor's degree in Business, Information Systems, Computer Science, Analytics, or a related field, or equivalent professional experience.

Preferred Qualifications

- Experience supporting **retail, store operations, inventory, supply chain, warehouse, or distribution** functions.
- Experience with **Snowflake** or another cloud data warehouse.
- Working knowledge of **Python/Pandas** for analysis or reporting automation.
- Exposure to **Azure Data Factory** or comparable data-integration environments.
- Experience working with **ERP/WMS/SAP** data.
- Experience documenting process flows and current-state/future-state workflows.
- Experience troubleshooting reporting issues involving multiple source systems.
- Experience working in an Agile environment with business and technical teams.

Interview Process

1. **Technical / Business Analysis Screening**
2. **Client Hiring Manager Interview**
3. **Client Selection → Compliance / Onboarding**

Submission Requirements

- Confirmed availability to work **onsite in New York, NY**
- Confirmed availability for **September 21, 2026** start
- Acceptance of **W2 employment terms**
- Verified work authorization, per client policy

- Ability to discuss hands-on experience with:
 - Business requirements gathering
 - KPI/reporting definition
 - SQL-based analysis and data reconciliation
 - Power BI/Tableau dashboard development
 - Stakeholder communication
 - At least one business reporting/dashboard solution delivered end-to-end